

Bhagavad Gita - Chapter 3

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

027. Chapter 3 Verses 1-3

VERSE 3.1

अर्जुन उवाच ।
ज्यायसी चेत्कर्मणस्ते मता बुद्धिर्जनार्दन ।
तत्किं कर्मणि घोरे मां नियोजयसि केशव ॥१॥

arjuna uvāca |
jyāyasī cetkarmaṇaste
matā buddhirjanārdana |
tatkiṃ karmaṇi ghore māṃ
niyojayasi keśava ||

- ◆ **arjunaḥ uvāca** – Arjuna said;
- ◆ **jyāyasī** – superior; **cet** – if; **karmaṇaḥ** – than action; **te** – by You;
- ◆ **matā** – thought; **buddhiḥ** – intellect/wisdom; **janārdana** – O Janardana;
- ◆ **tat** – then; **kim** – why; **karmaṇi** – in action; **ghore** – ghastly/terrible; **mām** – me;
- ◆ **niyojayasi** – You engage; **keśava** – O Kesava.

Arjuna said: O Krishna! If your belief is that knowledge is superior to action, then why do you engage me in this dreadful act of battle?

VERSE 3.2

व्यामिश्रेणेव वाक्येन बुद्धिं मोहयसीव मे ।
तदेकं वद निश्चित्य येन श्रेयोऽहमाप्नुयाम् ॥ २ ॥

vyāmiśreṇeva vākyaena
buddhiṃ mohayasīva me |
tadekaṃ vada niścitya
yena śreya'hamāpnuyām ||

- ◆ **vyāmiśreṇa** – equivocal/confusing; **iva** – as if; **vākyaena** – by words;
- ◆ **buddhim** – intellect; **mohayasi** – You confuse; **iva** – as it were; **me** – my;
- ◆ **tat** – that; **ekam** – one; **vada** – tell; **niścitya** – decisively;
- ◆ **yena** – by which; **śreyaḥ** – the highest good; **aham** – I; **āpnuyām** – may attain.

With these apparently contradictory words, You seem to confuse my understanding. Therefore tell me definitely that one thing by which I shall reach the Highest Goal.

VERSE 3.3

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।

लोकेऽस्मिन्द्विविधा निष्ठा पुरा प्रोक्ता मया नघ ।

ज्ञानयोगेन साङ्ख्यानां कर्मयोगेन योगिनाम् ॥३॥

śrībhagavānuvāca |

loke'smindvividhā niṣṭhā

purā proktā mayānagha |

jñānayogena sāṅkhyānām

karmayogena yoginām ||

◆ **śrī-bhagavān uvāca** – The Blessed Lord said;

◆ **loke** – in the world; **asmin** – in this; **dvividhā** – two-fold; **niṣṭhā** – path/discipline;

◆ **purā** – formerly; **proktā** – was declared; **mayā** – by Me; **anagha** – O sinless one;

◆ **jñāna-yogena** – by the path of Knowledge; **sāṅkhyānām** – for the Sankhyas; **karma-yogena** – by the path of Action; **yoginām** – for the Yogis.

The Blessed Lord said: O sinless Arjuna! In ancient times two paths of spiritual description were spoken by me – the Jnana yoga for the followers of the path of knowledge, and Karma yoga for the followers of the path of action.

028. Chapter 3 Verses 4-6

VERSE 3.4

न कर्मणामनारम्भान्नैष्कर्म्यं पुरुषोऽश्नुते ।
न च संन्यसनादेव सिद्धिं समधिगच्छति ॥४॥

na karmaṇāmanārambhān
naiṣkarmyaṃ puruṣo'śnute |
na ca sannyasanādeva
siddhiṃ samadhigacchati ||

- ◆ **na** – not; **karmaṇām** – of actions; **anārambhāt** – from non-performance;
- ◆ **naiṣkarmyam** – freedom from action; **puruṣaḥ** – a man; **aśnute** – attains;
- ◆ **na** – not; **ca** – and; **sannyasanāt** – from renunciation; **eva** – only;
- ◆ **siddhim** – perfection; **samadhigacchati** – attains.

Man does not match the actionless state of Brahman by mere non-performance of work, nor does he attain perfection by renunciation only.

VERSE 3.5

न हि कश्चित्क्षणमपि जातु तिष्ठत्यकर्मकृत् ।
कार्यते ह्यवशः कर्म सर्वः प्रकृतिजैर्गुणैः ॥ ५ ॥

na hi kaścitkṣaṇamapi
jātu tiṣṭhatyakarmakṛt |
kāryate hyavaśaḥ karma
sarvaḥ prakṛtijairguṇaiḥ ||

- ◆ **na** – not; **hi** – indeed; **kaścit** – anyone; **kṣaṇam** – a moment; **api** – even;
- ◆ **jātu** – ever; **tiṣṭhati** – remains; **akarma-kṛt** – without performing action;
- ◆ **kāryate** – is made to do; **hi** – for; **avaśaḥ** – helplessly; **karma** – action;
- ◆ **sarvaḥ** – everyone; **prakṛti-jaiḥ** – born of nature; **guṇaiḥ** – by the Gunas (modes).

No one can live even for a moment without doing work.

Everyone without his will is made to do work by the qualities born of Prakriti.

VERSE 3.6

कर्मेन्द्रियाणि संयम्य य आस्ते मनसा स्मरन् ।
इन्द्रियार्थान्विमूढात्मा मिथ्याचारः स उच्यते ॥६॥

karmendriyāṇi saṁyamya
ya āste manasā smaran |
indriyārthānvimūḍhātmā
mithyācāraḥ sa ucyate ||

- ◆ **karma-indriyāṇi** – the organs of action; **saṁyamya** – restraining;
- ◆ **yaḥ** – who; **āste** – sits; **manasā** – with the mind; **smaran** – dwelling upon;
- ◆ **indriya-arthān** – objects of the senses; **vimūḍha-ātmā** – of deluded soul;
- ◆ **mithyā-ācāraḥ** – hypocrite; **saḥ** – he; **ucyate** – is called.

The man of deluded understanding who restraining the organs of the action sits contemplating the sense objects with the mind is called a hypocrite.

029. Chapter 3 Verses 7-8

VERSE 3.7

यस्त्विन्द्रियाणि मनसा नियम्यारभतेऽर्जुन ।
कर्मेन्द्रियैः कर्मयोगमसक्तः स विशिष्यते ॥ ७ ॥

yastvindriyāṇi manasā
niyamyārabhate'rjuna |
karmendriyaiḥ karmayogam
asaktaḥ sa viśiṣyate ||

yaḥ – who; **tu** – but; **indriyāṇi** – the senses; **manasā** – by the mind;
niyamyā – controlling; **ārabhate** – begins/engages in; **arjuna** – O Arjuna;
karma-indriyaiḥ – by the organs of action; **karma-yogam** – Karma Yoga;
asaktaḥ – unattached; **saḥ** – he; **viśiṣyate** – is superior.

But, O Arjuna! he who controls the senses with the mind, and commences the discipline of Karma yoga by his organs of action without attachment, is the best.

VERSE 3.8

नियतं कुरु कर्म त्वं कर्म ज्यायो ह्यकर्मणः ।
शरीरयात्रापि च ते न प्रसिद्ध्येदकर्मणः ॥ ८ ॥

niyataṁ kuru karma tvam
karma jyāyo hyakarmaṇaḥ |
śarīrayātrāpi ca te
na prasiddhyedakarmaṇaḥ ||

- ◆ **niyatam** – prescribed/obligatory; **kuru** – perform;
- ◆ **karma** – action; **tvam** – you; **karma** – action; **jyāyaḥ** – superior; **hi** – indeed; **akarmanah** – than inaction;
- ◆ **śarīra-yātrā** – maintenance of the body; **api** – even; **ca** – and; **te** – your;
- ◆ **na prasiddhyet** – would not be possible; **akarmanah** – through inaction.

Doing the work prescribed by the Sastras is superior to inaction. By inaction, even maintenance of the body for you would not be possible

030. Chapter 3 Verses 9-16

VERSE 3.9

यज्ञार्थात्कर्मणोऽन्यत्र लोकोऽयं कर्मबन्धनः ।
तदर्थं कर्म कौन्तेय मुक्तसङ्गः समाचर ॥९॥

yajñārthātkarmaṇo'nyatra
loko'yaṁ karmabandhanaḥ |
tadārthaṁ karma kaunteya
muktasaṅgaḥ samācara ||

yajña-arthāt – for the sake of sacrifice (Yajna); **karmaṇaḥ** – than action;
anyatra – otherwise;
lokaḥ ayam – this world; **karma-bandhanaḥ** – bound by action;
tat-arthaṁ – for that sake; **karma** – action; **kaunteya** – O son of Kunti;
mukta-saṅgaḥ – free from attachment; **samācara** – perform well.

O Arjuna! Works other than those performed for the sake of sacrifice (Yajna) binds this world. So perform work for sacrifice without attachment.

VERSE 3.10

सहयज्ञाः प्रजाः सृष्ट्वा पुरोवाच प्रजापतिः ।
अनेन प्रसविष्यध्वमेष वोऽस्त्विष्टकामधुक् ॥ 10 ॥

sahayajñāḥ prajāḥ sṛṣṭvā
purovāca prajāpatiḥ |
anena prasaviṣyadhvam
eṣa vo'stviṣṭakāmadhuk ||

saha-yajñāḥ – along with sacrifice; **prajāḥ** – mankind/beings; **sṛṣṭvā** – having created;
purā – in the beginning; **uvāca** – said; **prajāpatiḥ** – Prajapati (the Creator);
anena – by this; **prasaviṣyadhvam** – shall you multiply/prosper;
eṣaḥ – this; **vaḥ** – for you; **astu** – let be; **iṣṭa-kāma-dhuk** – the milch-cow of your desires.

Having created mankind together with yajna in the beginning, Brahma (Creator) said – “By this shall you propagate; it shall be to you the milk-cow of desires, the wish-fulfilling heavenly cow Kamadhenu.”

VERSE 3.11

देवान्भावयतानेन ते देवा भावयन्तु वः ।
परस्परं भावयन्तः श्रेयः परमवाप्स्यथ ॥ 11 ॥

devānbhāvayatānena
te devā bhāvayantu vaḥ |
parasparam bhāvayantaḥ
śreyaḥ paramavāpsyatha ||

devān – the gods; **bhāvayatā** – nourish/foster; **anena** – by this;
te – those; **devāḥ** – gods; **bhāvayantu** – may nourish; **vaḥ** – you;
parasparam – one another; **bhāvayantaḥ** – nourishing;
śreyaḥ – the highest good; **param** – supreme; **avāpsyatha** – you shall attain.

**Nourish the Gods with Yajna, and they shall nourish you, and
thus nourishing one another both men and Gods you shall
attain the highest good.**

VERSE 3.12

इष्टान्भोगान्हि वो देवा दास्यन्ते यज्ञभाविताः ।
तैर्दत्तानप्रदायैभ्यो यो भुङ्क्ते स्तेन एव सः ॥ 12 ॥

iṣṭānbhogānhi vo devā
dāsyante yajñabhāvitāḥ |
tairdattānapradāyaibhyo
yo bhuṅkte stena eva saḥ ||

iṣṭān – desired; **bhogān** – enjoyments; **hi** – indeed; **vaḥ** – to you; **devāḥ** – the gods;

dāsyante – will give; **yajña-bhāvitāḥ** – nourished by sacrifice;

taiḥ – by them; **dattān** – given; **apradāya** – without offering; **ebhyaḥ** – to them; **yaḥ** – who; **bhuṅkte** – enjoys; **stenaḥ** – thief; **eva** – certainly; **saḥ** – he.

Nourished by sacrifice, the Gods, give you desirable enjoyments. He who enjoys objects given by the Gods without offering them is verily a thief.

VERSE 3.13

यज्ञशिष्टाशिनः सन्तो मुच्यन्ते सर्वकिल्बिषैः ।
भुञ्जते ते त्वघं पापा ये पचन्त्यात्मकारणात् ॥ 13 ॥

yajñaśiṣṭāśinaḥ santo
mucyante sarvakilbiṣaiḥ |
bhuñjate te tvaghaṁ pāpā
ye pacantyātmakāraṇāt ||

yajña-śiṣṭa – remnants of sacrifice; āśinaḥ – eaters; santaḥ – virtuous people;
mucyante – are freed; sarva – all; kilbiṣaiḥ – from sins;
bhuñjate – eat; te – they; tu – but; agham – sin; pāpāḥ – sinful ones;
ye – who; pacanti – cook; ātma-kāraṇāt – for their own sake.

The righteous who offer food to the Gods in sacrifice and eat the remnants are freed from all sins. But those who cook food to satisfy their own needs, are sinners and verily eat sin.

VERSE 3.14-15

अन्नाद्भवन्ति भूतानि पर्जन्यादन्नसम्भवः ।
यज्ञाद्भवति पर्जन्यो यज्ञः कर्मसमुद्भवः ॥ 14 ॥

कर्म ब्रह्मोद्भवं विद्धि ब्रह्माक्षरसमुद्भवम् ।
तस्मात्सर्वगतं ब्रह्म नित्यं यज्ञे प्रतिष्ठितम् ॥ 15 ॥

annādbhavanti bhūtāni
parjanyaādannasambhavaḥ |
yajñādbhavati parjanya
yajñaḥ karmasamudbhavaḥ ||

Beings are born of food, food is produced from rain, rain arises from yajna, yajna is born of action, action arises from Vedas, Vedas are born from the Imperishable Paramatma; therefore know that the Supreme Being is established in the yajna.

VERSE 3.16

एवं प्रवर्तितं चक्रं नानुवर्तयतीह यः ।
अघायुरिन्द्रियारामो मोघं पार्थ स जीवति ॥ 16 ॥

evam pravartitaṁ cakram
nānuvartayatiha yaḥ |
aghāyurindriyārāmo
moghaṁ pārtha sa jīvati ||

- ◆ **evam** – thus; **pravartitam** – set in motion; **cakram** – wheel;
- ◆ **na** – not; **anuvartayati** – follows; **iha** – in this world; **yaḥ** – who;
- ◆ **agha-āyuh** – living in sin; **indriya-ārāmaḥ** – rejoicing in the senses;
- ◆ **mogham** – in vain; **pārtha** – O Partha; **saḥ** – he; **jīvati** – lives.

The man who does not follow the cycle thus set revolving is a sinner rejoicing in sense-pleasures and he lives in vain.

031. Chapter 3 Verses 16-18

VERSE 3.16

एवं प्रवर्तितं चक्रं नानुवर्तयतीह यः ।
अघायुरिन्द्रियारामो मोघं पार्थ स जीवति ॥ 16 ॥

evam pravartitam cakram
nānuvartayatiha yaḥ |
aghāyurindriyārāmo
mogham pārtha sa jīvati ||

evam – thus; **pravartitam** – set in motion; **cakram** – wheel;
na – not; **anuvartayati** – follows; **iha** – in this world; **yaḥ** – who;
agha-āyuh – living in sin; **indriya-ārāmaḥ** – rejoicing in the senses;
mogham – in vain; **pārtha** – O Partha; **saḥ** – he; **jīvati** – lives.

The man who does not follow the cycle thus set revolving is a sinner rejoicing in sense-pleasures and he lives in vain.

VERSE 3.17

यस्त्वात्मरतिरेव स्यादात्मतृप्तश्च मानवः ।
आत्मन्येव च सन्तुष्टस्तस्य कार्यं न विद्यते ॥17॥

yastvātmaratireva syād
ātmatrptaśca mānavaḥ |
ātmanyevā ca santuṣṭas
tasya kāryaṃ na vidyate ||

yaḥ – who; **tu** – but; **ātma-ratiḥ** – rejoicing in the Self; **eva** – only; **syāt** – may be;

ātma-trptaḥ – satisfied with the Self; **ca** – and; **mānavaḥ** – a man;

ātmani – in the Self; **eva** – only; **ca** – and; **santuṣṭaḥ** – contented;

tasya – his; **kāryam** – duty/work; **na** – not; **vidyate** – exists.

**But he who rejoices, who is contented, who finds happiness
in Atma only, has no work to perform.**

VERSE 3.18

नैव तस्य कृतेनार्थो नाकृतेनेह कश्चन ।
न चास्य सर्वभूतेषु कश्चिदर्थव्यपाश्रयः ॥ 18 ॥

naiva tasya kṛtenārtho
nākṛteneha kaścana |
na cāsyā sarvabhūteṣu
kaścidadarthavyapāśrayaḥ ||

- ◆ **na** – not; **eva** – certainly; **tasya** – his; **kṛtena** – by action performed; **arthah** – use/interest;
- ◆ **na** – not; **akṛtena** – by action not performed; **iha** – here; **kaścana** – any;
- ◆ **na** – not; **ca** – and; **asya** – his; **sarva-bhūteṣu** – in all beings;
- ◆ **kaścit** – any; **artha-vyapāśrayaḥ** – dependence for any object.

For him, there is in this world no interest whatsoever by work done or not done. He does not depend upon any being for any object.

032. Chapter 3 Verses 19-21

VERSE 3.19

तस्मादसक्तः सततं कार्यं कर्म समाचर ।
असक्तो ह्याचरन्कर्म परमाप्नोति पूरुषः ॥ 19 ॥

tasmādasaktaḥ satataṁ
kāryaṁ karma samācara |
asakto hyācarankarma
paramāpnoti pūruṣaḥ ||

tasmāt – therefore; **asaktaḥ** – unattached; **satatam** – constantly;
kāryam – which ought to be done; **karma** – action; **samācara** – perform;
asaktaḥ – unattached; **hi** – indeed; **ācaran** – performing; **karma** – action;
param – the Supreme; **āpnoti** – attains; **pūruṣaḥ** – a man.

Therefore that work which should be done, do it well always without attachment. He who performs all the prescribed duties in a detached spirit will attain the Supreme.

VERSE 3.20

कर्मणैव हि संसिद्धिमास्थिता जनकादयः ।
लोकसंग्रहमेवापि सम्पश्यन्कर्तुमर्हसि ॥ 20 ॥

karmaṇaiva hi saṁsiddhim
āsthitā janakādayaḥ |
loka-saṅgrahamēvāpi
sampaśyankartumarhasi ||

karmaṇā – by action; **eva** – only; **hi** – indeed; **saṁsiddhim** – perfection;
āsthitāḥ – attained; **janaka-ādayaḥ** – Janaka and others;
loka-saṅgraham – welfare of the world; **eva** – only; **api** – also;
sampaśyan – having in view; **kartum** – to perform; **arhasi** – you should.

**King Janaka and others attained perfection by action. Even
having in view the need to show the right path to the masses,
you should work.**

VERSE 3.21

यद्यदाचरति श्रेष्ठस्तत्तदेवेतरो जनः ।
स यत्प्रमाणं कुरुते लोकस्तदनुवर्तते ॥ 21 ॥

yadyadācarati śreṣṭhas
tattadevetaro janah |
sa yatpramāṇam kurute
lokastadanuvartate ||

- ◆ **yat yat** – whatever; **ācarati** – does; **śreṣṭhah** – a great man;
- ◆ **tat tat** – that very thing; **eva** – only; **itarah** – other; **janah** – people;
- ◆ **saḥ** – he; **yat** – what; **pramāṇam** – standard/example; **kurute** – sets;
- ◆ **lokaḥ** – the world/people; **tat** – that; **anuvartate** – follows.

What-so-ever a great man does, that other men do; whatever he sets up as the standard, that the world follows.

033. Chapter 3 Verses 22-26

VERSE 3.22

न मे पार्थास्ति कर्तव्यं त्रिषु लोकेषु किञ्चन ।
नानवाप्तमवाप्तव्यं वर्त एव च कर्मणि ॥ 22 ॥

na me pārthāsti kartavyam
triṣu lokeṣu kiñcana |
nānavāptamavāptavyam
varta eva ca karmaṇi ||

- ◆ **na** – not; **me** – for Me; **pārtha** – O Partha; **asti** – is; **kartavyam** – duty;
- ◆ **triṣu** – in the three; **lokeṣu** – worlds; **kiñcana** – any;
- ◆ **na** – not; **anavāptam** – unattained; **avāptavyam** – to be attained;
- ◆ **varte** – I am engaged; **eva** – also; **ca** – and; **karmaṇi** – in action.

There is no duty for me to do in the three worlds. There is nothing unattained or to be attained for me. And yet I am also engaged in work.

VERSE 3.23

यदि ह्यहं न वर्तेयं जातु कर्मण्यतन्द्रितः ।
मम वर्त्मानुवर्तन्ते मनुष्याः पार्थ सर्वशः ॥ 23 ॥

yadi hyaham na varteyam
jātu karmaṇyatandritaḥ |
mama vartmānuvarta nte
manuṣyāḥ pārtha sarvaśaḥ ||

- ◆ **yadi** – if; **hi** – indeed; **aham** – I; **na** – not; **varteyam** – should engage;
- ◆ **jātu** – ever; **karmaṇi** – in action; **atandritaḥ** – tirelessly;
- ◆ **mama** – My; **vartma** – path; **anuvartante** – follow;
- ◆ **manuṣyāḥ** – men; **pārtha** – O Partha; **sarvaśaḥ** – in every way.

**If I am not engaged in action always, without relaxation,
men follow my path in every way, O Arjuna!**

VERSE 3.24

उत्सीदेयुरिमे लोका न कुर्यां कर्म चेदहम् ।
सङ्करस्य च कर्ता स्यामुपहन्यामिमाः प्रजाः ॥ 24 ॥

utsīdeyurime lokā
na kuryām karma cedaham |
saṅkarasya ca kartā syām
upahanyāmimāḥ prajāḥ ||

- ◆ **utsīdeyuh** – would perish; **ime** – these; **lokāḥ** – worlds;
- ◆ **na kuryām** – did not perform; **karma** – action; **cet** – if; **aham** – I;
- ◆ **saṅkarasya** – of confusion/admixture; **ca** – and; **kartā** – author; **syām** – I would be;
- ◆ **upahanyām** – would destroy; **imāḥ** – these; **prajāḥ** – beings.

These worlds would perish if I do not perform work; I would be the cause of the confusion of species and the destruction of these beings.

VERSE 3.25

सक्ताः कर्मण्यविद्वांसो यथा कुर्वन्ति भारत ।
कुर्याद्विद्वांस्तथासक्तश्चिकीर्षुर्लोकसंग्रहम् ॥ 25 ॥

saktāḥ karmaṇyavidvāṃso
yathā kurvanti bhārata |
kuryādvidvāṃstathāsakta
ścikīrṣurlokasaṅgraham ||

- ◆ **saktāḥ** – attached; **karmaṇi** – to action; **avidvāṃsaḥ** – the ignorant;
- ◆ **yathā** – as; **kurvanti** – perform; **bhārata** – O Bharata;
- ◆ **kuryāt** – should perform; **vidvān** – the wise; **tathā** – so; **asaktaḥ** – unattached;
- ◆ **cikīrṣuḥ** – wishing; **loka-saṅgraham** – welfare of the world.

O Arjuna! As the ignorant men work with attachment to action, so should the wise act without attachment, for the welfare of the world.

VERSE 3.26

न बुद्धिभेदं जनयेदज्ञानां कर्मसङ्गिनाम् ।
जोषयेत्सर्वकर्माणि विद्वान्युक्तः समाचरन् ॥ 26 ॥

na buddhibhedam janayed
ajñānām karmasaṅginām |
joṣayetsarvakarmāṇi
vidvānyuktaḥ samācaran ||

- ◆ **na** – not; **buddhi-bhedam** – confusion of intellect; **janayet** – should create;
- ◆ **ajñānām** – of the ignorant; **karma-saṅginām** – attached to action;
- ◆ **joṣayet** – should encourage/inspire; **sarva-karmāṇi** – all actions;
- ◆ **vidvān** – the wise; **yuktaḥ** – disciplined/steadfast; **samācaran** – performing well.

The wise man should not disturb and confuse the minds of the ignorant attached to action. By performing all actions with yogic equanimity, they should make the ignorant do accordingly.

034. Chapter 3 Verse 27

VERSE 3.27

प्रकृतेः क्रियमाणानि गुणैः कर्माणि सर्वशः ।
अहङ्कारविमूढात्मा कर्ताहमिति मन्यते ॥ 27 ॥

prakṛteḥ kriyamāṇāni
guṇaiḥ karmāṇi sarvaśaḥ |
ahaṅkāravimūḍhātmā
kartāhamiti manyate ||

- ◆ **prakṛteḥ** – of nature; **kriyamāṇāni** – are performed;
- ◆ **guṇaiḥ** – by the modes (Gunas); **karmāṇi** – actions; **sarvaśaḥ** – in all cases;
- ◆ **ahaṅkāra-vimūḍha-ātmā** – one whose mind is deluded by egoism;
- ◆ **kartā** – doer; **aham** – I; **iti** – thus; **manyate** – thinks.

By the qualities of nature, actions are performed in all cases, but one whose mind is deluded by egoism thinks “I am the doer”.

035. Chapter 3 Verses 28-29

VERSE 3.28

तत्त्ववित्तु महाबाहो गुणकर्मविभागयोः ।
गुणा गुणेषु वर्तन्त इति मत्वा न सज्जते ॥ 28 ॥

tattvavittu mahābāho
guṇakarmavibhāgayoḥ |
guṇā guṇeṣu vartanta
iti matvā na sajjate ||

- ◆ **tattva-vit** – knower of Truth; **tu** – but; **mahābāho** – O mighty-armed;
- ◆ **guṇa-karma-vibhāgayoḥ** – of the divisions of modes and actions;
- ◆ **guṇāḥ** – the modes; **guṇeṣu** – in the modes; **vartante** – operate;
- ◆ **iti** – thus; **matvā** – knowing; **na** – not; **sajjate** – becomes attached.

O mighty-armed Arjuna! But the knower of Truth understands the divisions of qualities and functions. He knows that the qualities in the form of senses function amidst the objects of the senses, and he, as the Supreme Self, is not affected by them. Thus knowing, he remains unattached.

VERSE 3.29

प्रकृतेर्गुणसम्मूढाः सज्जन्ते गुणकर्मसु ।
तानकृत्स्नविदो मन्दान्कृत्स्नविन्न विचालयेत् ॥ 29 ॥

prakṛterguṇasammūḍhāḥ
sajjante guṇakarmasu |
tānakṛtsnavido mandān
kṛtsnavinna vicālayet ||

- ◆ **prakṛteḥ** – of nature; **guṇa-sammūḍhāḥ** – deluded by the modes;
- ◆ **sajjante** – become attached; **guṇa-karmasu** – to the actions of the modes;
- ◆ **tān** – those; **akṛtsna-vidah** – of imperfect knowledge; **mandān** – the dull-witted;
- ◆ **kṛtsna-vit** – the knower of the Whole (the wise); **na** – not; **vicālayet** – should unsettle.

The man of knowledge should not confuse the mind of those men of imperfect understanding who, deluded by the Gunas of Nature, are attached to action in the material world.

036. Chapter 3 Vers 30

VERSE 3.30

मयि सर्वाणि कर्माणि संन्यस्याध्यात्मचेतसा ।
निराशीर्निर्ममो भूत्वा युध्यस्व विगतज्वरः ॥ 30 ॥

mayi sarvāṇi karmāṇi
sannyasyādhyātmacetasā |
nirāśīrnirmamo bhūtvā
yudhyasva vigatajvaraḥ ||

- ◆ **mayi** – in Me; **sarvāṇi** – all; **karmāṇi** – actions;
- ◆ **sannyasya** – surrendering; **adhyātma-cetasā** – with the mind fixed on the Self;
- ◆ **nirāśīḥ** – free from hope/expectation; **nirmamaḥ** – free from 'mine-ness'; **bhūtvā** – becoming;
- ◆ **yudhyasva** – fight; **vigata-jvaraḥ** – free from mental fever/anxiety.

Renouncing all actions in Me with the mind fixed in Self, free from hope and egoism, fight without mental agitation.

037. Chapter 3 Vers 31

VERSE 3.31

ये मे मतमिदं नित्यमनुतिष्ठन्ति मानवाः ।
श्रद्धावन्तोऽनसूयन्तो मुच्यन्ते तेऽपि कर्मभिः ॥ 31 ॥

ye me matamidaṃ nityam
anutiṣṭhanti mānavāḥ |
śraddhāvanto'nasūyanto
mucyante te'pi karmabhiḥ ||

- ◆ **ye** – who; **me** – My; **matam** – teaching; **idam** – this; **nityam** – constantly;
- ◆ **anutiṣṭhanti** – follow; **mānavāḥ** – men;
- ◆ **śraddhāvantaḥ** – full of faith; **anasūyantaḥ** – free from cavil/envy;
- ◆ **mucyante** – are freed; **te api** – they also; **karmabhiḥ** – from (the bondage of) actions.

**Those men who, with faith and free from ill-will, practice
this my teaching, are also freed from the bondage of action.**

038. Chapter 3 Verses 32-34

VERSE 3.32

ये त्वेतदभ्यसूयन्तो नानुतिष्ठन्ति मे मतम् ।
सर्वज्ञानविमूढांस्तान्विद्धि नष्टानचेतसः ॥ 32 ॥

ye tvetadabhyasūyanto
nānutiṣṭhanti me matam |
sarvajñānavimūḍhāmstān
viddhi naṣṭānacetasah ||

- ◆ **ye** – who; **tu** – but; **etat** – this; **abhyasūyantaḥ** – cavilling/sneering;
- ◆ **na anutiṣṭhanti** – do not follow; **me** – My; **matam** – teaching;
- ◆ **sarva-jñāna** – in all knowledge; **vimūḍhān** – deluded; **tān** – them;
- ◆ **viddhi** – know; **naṣṭān** – ruined; **acetasah** – mindless/devoid of discrimination.

**But those who carp at my teaching and do not practise it,
know them as men deluded in all knowledge, devoid of
discrimination and doomed to destruction.**

VERSE 3.33

सदृशं चेष्टते स्वस्याः प्रकृतेर्ज्ञानवानपि ।
प्रकृतिं यान्ति भूतानि निग्रहः किं करिष्यति ॥ ३३ ॥

sadrśaṃ ceṣṭate svasyāḥ
prakṛterjñānavanapi |
prakṛtiṃ yānti bhūtāni
nigrahaḥ kiṃ kariṣyati ||

- ◆ **sadrśam** – accordingly; **ceṣṭate** – acts; **svasyāḥ** – of his own;
- ◆ **prakṛteḥ** – nature; **jñānavān** – the wise; **api** – even;
- ◆ **prakṛtim** – nature; **yānti** – follow; **bhūtāni** – beings;
- ◆ **nigrahaḥ** – restraint; **kim** – what; **kariṣyati** – will do.

Even a wise man acts according to his own nature. Beings follow nature; what can restraint do?

VERSE 3.34

इन्द्रियस्येन्द्रियस्यार्थे रागद्वेषौ व्यवस्थितौ ।
तयोर्न वशमागच्छेत्तौ ह्यस्य परिपन्थिनौ ॥ 34 ॥

indriyasyendriyasyārthe
rāgadveṣau vyavasthitau |
tayorna vaśamāgacchetau
hyasya paripanthinau ||

- ◆ **indriyasya** – of the senses; **indriyasya arthe** – in the objects of the senses;
- ◆ **rāga-dveṣau** – attraction and aversion; **vyavasthitau** – reside;
- ◆ **tayoḥ** – of these two; **na** – not; **vaśam** – under the sway; **āgacchet** – should come; **tau** – these two;
- ◆ **hi** – indeed; **asya** – his; **paripanthinau** – foes/adversaries.

In each of the senses abide attraction and repulsion for the objects of the senses. One should not come under their sway, for they are man's enemies.

039. Chapter 3 Verses 35-37

VERSE 3.35

श्रेयान्स्वधर्मो विगुणः परधर्मात्स्वनुष्ठितात् ।
स्वधर्मे निधनं श्रेयः परधर्मो भयावहः ॥ 35 ॥

śreyānsvadharmo viguṇaḥ
paradharmātsvanuṣṭhitāt |
svadharṁe nidhanaṁ śreyaḥ
paradharmo bhayāvahaḥ ||

- ◆ **śreyān** – better; **sva-dharmaḥ** – one's own duty; **viguṇaḥ** – though devoid of merit;
- ◆ **paradharmāt** – than the duty of another; **su-anuṣṭhitāt** – well-performed;
- ◆ **svadharṁe** – in one's own duty; **nidhanam** – death; **śreyaḥ** – better;
- ◆ **para-dharmaḥ** – another's duty; **bhaya-āvahaḥ** – fraught with fear.

One's own duty, ill-performed and without merit, is better than the duty of another well-discharged. Better is death in discharging one's own duty. Another's duty is fraught with fear.

VERSE 3.36

अर्जुन उवाच ।

अथ केन प्रयुक्तोऽयं पापं चरति पूरुषः ।

अनिच्छन्नपि वार्ष्णेय बलादिव नियोजितः ॥ 36 ॥

arjuna uvāca |

atha kena prayukto'yaṁ

pāpaṁ carati pūruṣaḥ |

anicchannapi vārṣṇeya

balādiva niyojitaḥ ||

◆ **arjunaḥ uvāca** – Arjuna said;

◆ **atha** – then; **kena** – by what; **prayuktaḥ** – impelled; **ayaṁ** – this;

◆ **pāpaṁ** – sin; **carati** – commits; **pūruṣaḥ** – man;

◆ **anicchan** – not wishing; **api** – even; **vārṣṇeya** – O Varshneya (Krishna);

◆ **balāt** – by force; **iva** – as if; **niyojitaḥ** – constrained.

Arjuna said: O Krishna! Constrained by force as it were, by what does man commit sin even against his wish?

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।

काम एष क्रोध एष रजोगुणसमुद्भवः ॥

महाशनो महापाप्मा विद्ध्येनमिह वैरिणम् ॥ 37 ॥

śrībhagavānuvāca |

kāma eṣa krodha eṣa

rajoguṇasamudbhavaḥ |

mahāśano mahāpāpmā

viddhyenamiha vairiṇam ||

◆ śrī-bhagavān uvāca – The Blessed Lord said;

◆ kāmaḥ – desire; eṣaḥ – this; krodhaḥ – anger; eṣaḥ – this;

◆ rajo-guṇa – the mode of passion; samudbhavaḥ – born of;

◆ mahā-aśanaḥ – all-devouring; mahā-pāpmā – all-sinful;

◆ viddhi – know; enam – this; iha – here; vairiṇam – the enemy.

**The Blessed Lord said: It is desire, it is anger, born of
Rajoguna (the impulse of action), all-consuming and all-evil.
Know this as the enemy here.**

040. Chapter 3 Verses 38-39

VERSE 3.38

धूमेनाव्रियते वह्निर्यथादर्शो मलेन च ।
यथोल्बेनावृतो गर्भस्तथा तेनेदमावृतम् ॥ 38 ॥

dhūmenāvriyate vahniry
athādarśo malena ca |
yatholbenāvṛto garbhas
tathā tenedamāvṛtam ||

- ◆ **dhūmena** – by smoke; **āvriyate** – is covered; **vahniḥ** – fire; **yathā** – as;
- ◆ **ādarśaḥ** – mirror; **malena** – by dust/dirt; **ca** – and;
- ◆ **yathā** – as; **ulbena** – by the amnion (membrane); **āvṛtaḥ** – covered; **garbhaḥ** – embryo;
- ◆ **tathā** – so; **tenā** – by that (desire); **idam** – this (wisdom); **āvṛtam** – is covered.

As fire is enveloped by smoke, as a mirror by dust, as an embryo by the amnion, so this knowledge of the Self is enveloped by Kama and Krodha.

VERSE 3.39

आवृतं ज्ञानमेतेन ज्ञानिनो नित्यवैरिणा ।
कामरूपेण कौन्तेय दुष्पूरेणानलेन च ॥ 39 ॥

- ◆ āvṛtaṃ jñānametena
- ◆ jñānino nityavairiṇā |
- ◆ kāmarūpeṇa kaunteya
- ◆ duṣpūreṇānalena ca ||

āvṛtam – covered; **jñānam** – knowledge; **etena** – by this;
jñāninaḥ – of the wise; **nitya-vairiṇā** – by the eternal enemy;
kāma-rūpeṇa – in the form of desire; **kaunteya** – O son of Kunti;
duṣpūreṇa – insatiable; **analena** – fire; **ca** – and.
cha—and

**O Arjuna! Knowledge of the Self is covered by this
everlasting foe of the wise in the form of desire, insatiable
like fire.**

041. Chapter 3 Verses 40-42

VERSE 3.40

इन्द्रियाणि मनो बुद्धिरस्याधिष्ठानमुच्यते ।
एतैर्विमोहयत्येष ज्ञानमावृत्य देहिनम् ॥ 40 ॥

indriyāṇi mano buddhir
asyādhiṣṭhānamucyate |
etairvimohayatyeṣa
jñānamāvṛtya dehinam ||

- ◆ **indriyāṇi** – the senses; **manaḥ** – the mind; **buddhiḥ** – the intellect;
- ◆ **asya** – its; **adhiṣṭhānam** – seat/abode; **ucyate** – is called;
- ◆ **etaiḥ** – by these; **vimohayati** – deludes; **eṣaḥ** – this (desire);
- ◆ **jñānam** – knowledge; **āvṛtya** – covering; **dehinam** – the embodied soul.

The senses, the mind, and the intellect are the seat of kama. Functioning through them this kama deluded the embodied by veiling the wisdom.

VERSE 3.41

तस्मात्त्वमिन्द्रियाण्यादौ नियम्य भरतर्षभ ।
पाप्मानं प्रजहि ह्येनं ज्ञानविज्ञाननाशनम् ॥ 41 ॥

tasmāttvamindriyāṇyādau
niyamyā bharatarṣabha |
pāpmānaṁ prajahi hyenaṁ
jñānavijñānanāśanam ||

- ◆ **tasmāt** – therefore; **tvam** – you; **indriyāṇi** – the senses; **ādau** – in the beginning;
- ◆ **niyamyā** – controlling; **bharata-rṣabha** – O best of the Bharatas;
- ◆ **pāpmānaṁ** – the sinful; **prajahi** – slay; **hi** – indeed; **enam** – this (desire);
- ◆ **jñāna-vijñāna** – of knowledge and realization; **nāśanam** – destroyer.

O Arjuna! Therefore, having controlled the senses in the beginning, kill surely this kama, the sinful destroyer of knowledge and Self-realisation.

VERSE 3.42

इन्द्रियाणि पराण्याहुरिन्द्रियेभ्यः परं मनः ।
मनसस्तु परा बुद्धिर्यो बुद्धेः परतस्तु सः ॥ 42 ॥

indriyāṇi parāṇyāhur
indriyebhyas param manah |
manasastu parā buddhir
yobuddheḥ paratastu saḥ ||

- ◆ **indriyāṇi** – the senses; **parāṇi** – superior; **āhuḥ** – they say;
- ◆ **indriyebhyaḥ** – than the senses; **param** – superior; **manah** – the mind;
- ◆ **manasaḥ** – than the mind; **tu** – but; **parā** – superior; **buddhiḥ** – the intellect;
- ◆ **yaḥ** – who; **buddheḥ** – than the intellect; **parataḥ** – superior; **tu** – but; **saḥ** – He (the Soul).

They say that the senses are superior (to the body), superior to the senses is the mind, superior to the mind is the intellect, but superior than the intellect is He (the Atman).

042. Chapter 3 Verse 43 - Ch3 Overview

VERSE 3.43

एवं बुद्धेः परं बुद्ध्वा संस्तभ्यात्मानमात्मना ।
जहि शत्रुं महाबाहो कामरूपं दुरासदम् ॥ 43 ॥

evam buddheḥ param buddhvā
saṁsthabhyātmānamātmanā |
jahi śatrum mahābāho
kāmarūpaṁ durāsadam ||

- ◆ **evam** – thus; **buddheḥ** – than the intellect; **param** – superior; **buddhvā** – knowing;
- ◆ **saṁsthabhya** – subduing; **ātmānam** – the self (lower self); **ātmanā** – by the Self (higher self);
- ◆ **jahi** – kill; **śatrum** – the enemy; **mahābāho** – O mighty-armed;
- ◆ **kāma-rūpaṁ** – in the form of desire; **durāsadam** – difficult to conquer.

O mighty-armed Arjuna! Thus, having known what is greater than the intellect (i.e.) Atma, and restraining the mind by the intellect conquer the foe (kama) in the form of desire which is indeed hard to overcome.